

n8n Installation Guide

Introduction

This guide explains two beginner-friendly ways to install n8n: using Node.js (npm) and using Docker.

Method 1: Install with Node.js

1. Install Node.js LTS from nodejs.org.
2. Verify: `node -v` and `npm -v`.
3. Install: `npm install -g n8n`
4. Start: `n8n`
5. Open <http://localhost:5678> and create your owner account.
6. Stop with `Ctrl+C`. Update using `npm install -g n8n@latest`.

Method 2: Install with Docker

1. Install Docker Desktop.
2. Verify: `docker --version`.
3. Create volume: `docker volume create n8n_data`
4. Run:
`docker run -it --name n8n -p 5678:5678 -v n8n_data:/home/node/.n8n docker.n8n.io/n8nio/n8n`
5. Visit <http://localhost:5678>.
6. Stop: `docker stop n8n`
7. Start: `docker start n8n`
8. Remove: `docker rm -f n8n`

Docker Compose

Create `compose.yaml` with n8n service mapping port 5678 and volume `n8n_data`. Run: `docker compose up -d`. Stop: `docker compose down`. Update: `docker compose pull`  `docker compose up -d`.

Troubleshooting

If port 5678 is busy, stop the conflicting app or map another port like 5679:5678. Ensure Docker is running. Verify Node.js version if npm install fails.

Recommendation

For learning, Node.js is simplest. For long-term and production, Docker or Docker Compose is recommended because updates and backups are easier.